

CINEMA

The 2025 Slate

The Indian film industry is hoping that 2025 will mark the return of big-budget blockbusters

BY KRISHNA GOPALAN



► **THERE IS A** sense of quiet optimism in the Indian film industries about 2025. And it's not hard to see why. If 2024 was marked by the relative absence of big-budget movies, especially the three Khans (Shah Rukh, Salman, and Aamir), at the box office, 2025 is set to change that.

Looking back, Sanjay Mehta, Delhi-based distributor and proprietor of Bobby Enterprises, says

THEATRICAL PERFORMANCE IS VERY IMPORTANT, AS OTT PLATFORMS LOOK AT THAT BEFORE ACQUIRING MOVIES

2024 was a “content-driven year,” citing the success of *Bhool Bhulaiyaa 3*, which made a little over ₹400 crore globally with over ₹260 crore from India. “Plus, we had the big-budget *Indian 2* bombing. All that made 2024 very interesting and different.” There were notable successes, of course, like *Pushpa: The Rule*, *Kalki 2898 AD*, *Stree 2*, *Singham Again*, and *Bramayugam*.